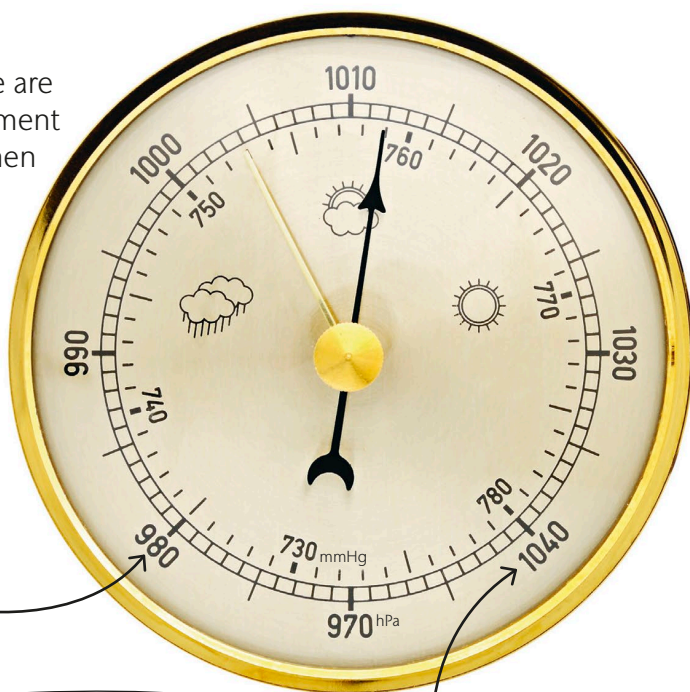


Under pressure

You can't feel it, but the air is pushing down on you all the time. This push is called air pressure. Sometimes pressure is high; sometimes it is low. Changes in air pressure bring changes in the weather and make winds blow.

Ups and downs

Changes in air pressure are measured on an instrument called a barometer. When pressure is low, the weather is often wet and cloudy. When it is high, the weather is usually dry and clear.



When the air pressure drops, stormy weather is on the way.

This barometer measures pressure in units called hectopascals (hPa), which are the equivalent of millibars (mb).

When air pressure stays high, the weather is likely to stay clear.